

Oct 10, 2025

Meeting Oct 10, 2025 at 12:10 CEST

Meeting records  Recording

Summary

Clément Lacaille introduced HTTP, JSON, and API using a pizza shop analogy, and then outlined the day's automation task: to complete a video generation workflow on Zapier involving webhooks, JSON, and an API key. Clément Lacaille guided participants through configuring the Zapier workflow, including setting up webhooks, entering JSON payload details, and implementing a delay node, while troubleshooting issues like API key problems with Naim Burrack, content-related errors with Naim Burrack, and spreadsheet mapping difficulties with Sara Hofmann and Patrick Wode. Christian Dammann successfully generated a video, and Clément Lacaille clarified certificate requirements, while also offering individual support to Naim Burrack and Patrick Wode with their workflows.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Google Drive Access for Meeting Materials** Naim Burrack suggested adding meeting materials to the Google Drive for intuitive access. Clément Lacaille acknowledged this, explaining that they were unable to do so earlier due to a prior meeting but would address it after class.
- **Introduction to HTTP, JSON, and API** Clément Lacaille provided an introductory explanation of HTTP, JSON, and API using a pizza shop analogy. They described HTTP as the "road" for information transfer on the internet, JSON as a "pizza box" for neatly packaging data in a standardized format for applications, and API as the "waiter" that takes orders and facilitates communication between the user

and the service. Clément Lacaille encouraged participants to use Postman to practice with APIs and simplify their understanding of these concepts.

- **Today's Automation Task** Clément Lacaille outlined the day's task: to complete an automation workflow on Zapier for a first portfolio project, specifically focusing on video generation. They explained that the process would involve using webhooks to call a service, JSON to communicate messages, and an API key for authorization.
- **Manual Video Generation Test** Clément Lacaille demonstrated a manual test of the video generation by running a GPT-generated prompt on the platform Falli, using the Sora 2 image to video model. They showed the desired video quality, including a 6-second vertical shot with specific subject and product details, and confirmed the output was satisfactory. Clément Lacaille also mentioned testing with MiniAx, a cheaper model without audio, which still produced decent quality.
- **Choosing AI Models for Specific Tasks** Clément Lacaille advised on selecting appropriate AI models for different tasks. They recommended Publexity for API documentation and search-based functions due to its crisp answers and good web option, and Claude for writing code. They also noted that Publexity offers access to various models, including Gemini, Sonar, Claude, GPT-3, GPT-5, and Grock.
- **Configuring the Zapier Workflow** Clément Lacaille guided participants on setting up the Zapier workflow for video generation. This involved writing a detailed prompt for Publexity to get step-by-step instructions on building the workflow, including specifics for filling webhook nodes, URL, headers, JSON payload, and API key. They emphasized using the Sora 2 image to video model.
- **Setting Up Webhooks in Zapier** Clément Lacaille instructed participants to configure the webhook action in Zapier by choosing "Custom Request" as the action event. They explained that "Post" is used for sending requests, like placing an order, and provided the specific URL endpoint for the service. Sara Hofmann sought clarification on the URL, which Clément Lacaille confirmed should be the same for everyone.
- **Entering JSON Payload Details** Clément Lacaille demonstrated how to enter JSON payload details, including the "prompt" key linked to the video script and the "product_image" for the image URL. They also specified that duration and aspect ratio should be numeric values, setting the duration to 4 seconds and the aspect ratio to 9:16 to manage credit usage. Julius-Jonas Steffen inquired about

changing the script duration, and Clément Lacaille reiterated the 4-second duration for testing purposes.

- **Setting Up API Key and Content Type** Clément Lacaille guided participants to set up the API key for authorization by typing "Authorization" followed by "Key" and the actual API key in the headers field. They stressed the importance of exact formatting. Additionally, they instructed to set the "Content-Type" header to "application/JSON".
- **Implementing a Delay Node** After testing the initial request, Clément Lacaille introduced a delay node in the Zapier workflow to account for the time required for video generation. They explained that this "wait" node, set to 1 minute, is crucial to ensure the service has enough time to generate the video before attempting to retrieve a response.
- **Retrieving Video Status with a Get Node** Clément Lacaille then moved on to setting up a "get" node using another webhook to retrieve the status of the generated video. They provided the URL for the status endpoint and instructed participants to include the request ID from the previous "post" step, along with the same authorization and content type headers. Clément Lacaille acknowledged an error message when testing the get node, indicating a potential issue with the endpoint for Sora 2.
- **Troubleshooting Video Generation Status** Clément Lacaille troubleshooted an issue where a video generation request was not providing a video URL but instead a "status URL". They explained that the "status URL" could be used to check the video's status (queued, in progress, completed, or failed), but a different request would be needed to get the actual video URL. Naim Burrack confirmed that their video generation request had worked, leading to a discussion about sharing screens to resolve the issue.
- **Identifying and Resolving API Key Issues** Clément Lacaille encountered an "Invalid API key" error when attempting to retrieve the video URL. They explained that the API key was previously working and decided to delete the problematic node and try running it again with the same key. However, as the issue persisted, Naim Burrack suggested that the key might have been compromised, prompting Clément to create a new API key and update it across all relevant nodes.
- **Workflow Adjustment and API Key Update** Clément Lacaille instructed participants to remove the "duration" parameter from the post node and update the API key with the newly generated one. They emphasized that the "duration"

parameter was causing an error in the input. Clément also clarified that for Zapier, two "get" webhook nodes using "response URL" were needed to first get the status and then the video URL, which was specific to that platform.

- **Resolving Content-Related Issues** Naim Burrack encountered an error message indicating that the content was flagged by a content checker, suggesting an issue with the prompt. Clément Lacaille clarified that the prompt contained sensitive or copyrighted material, which was not accepted by the model. They offered to work individually with Naim to resolve the prompt issue after the class.
- **Successful Video Generation and Output** Christian Dammann successfully generated a video after following Clément Lacaille's guidance to remove the "duration" field in the post node and correctly map the video URL to the spreadsheet output. Christian confirmed the successful video generation and shared it with the class. Clément congratulated them on completing their first automation.
- **Addressing Video Duration Discrepancy** Sara Hofmann inquired why their generated video was 4 seconds long despite their prompt requesting a 6-second video. Clément Lacaille explained that removing the "duration" step due to JSON structure issues caused the system to default to the lowest duration, which was 4 seconds. They noted that to get a specific duration, it must be explicitly specified in the prompt.
- **Resolving Spreadsheet Mapping and Image Input Errors** Sara Hofmann initially struggled to map the video URL to their spreadsheet due to an unconfigured step. Clément Lacaille guided Sara to correctly map the video URL from the seventh node to the spreadsheet, which resolved the issue. Patrick Wode faced an error where their process skipped the "zap data" and they did not receive a URL, which Clément determined was due to using an invalid Google image URL instead of a Cloudinary URL.
- **Understanding Certificate Requirements** Christian Dammann asked about the requirements for earning a certificate, specifically if attendance was sufficient or if practical application was needed. Clément Lacaille clarified that participants must build the projects demonstrated in class and showcase their own projects based on the workflow to receive a certificate, rather than just attending the sessions.
- **Discussion on "Get" Request Usage** Sven Lück questioned the necessity of using two "get" requests after the delay, stating that they only used one and still

obtained the video. Clément Lacaille explained that Zapier's documentation suggested two "get" nodes: one for status and one for the URL, differing from N8's behavior where both nodes were the same. Sven suggested that the two requests might be due to Zapier's handling of asynchronous operations, ensuring the video is fully generated before attempting to retrieve it.

- **Addressing Technical Difficulties and Next Steps** Clément Lacaille asked Christian Dammann if they were able to attempt building the workflow. Christian Dammann indicated they built it by following the instructions but would struggle to replicate it without rewatching the classes, citing language and pronunciation differences as difficulties. Clément Lacaille acknowledged this, expressed the importance of sharing screenshots of completed automation on the Slack group for others to review, and announced that they would begin working with N8N next week, with public access to N8N provided by Tuesday for those unable to set it up locally.
- **Individual Support and Feedback** Clément Lacaille offered to stay back and help Naim Burrack and Patrick Wode, who were experiencing issues, while allowing others to leave. Clément Lacaille also mentioned that a feedback form would be shared to gather honest feedback on how to improve for the next week, as this was the first week.
- **Troubleshooting Patrick Wode's Workflow** Patrick Wode initially had a copy-paste mistake with a URL, which they corrected, making their workflow functional. Clément Lacaille guided Patrick Wode through a test run of their Zapier workflow, troubleshooting issues related to data display and ensuring the correct row was selected for testing. After adjusting the delay, the video generation process completed successfully, creating a video of a toothbrush.
- **Troubleshooting Naim Burrack's Workflow - Copyright Issues** Naim Burrack explained they had removed mentions of licensed heroes from their Google Sheets and main ChatGPT prompt to avoid copyright issues, using generic descriptions instead. However, Naim Burrack continued to face an issue where the system was still pulling old hero names, suggesting a delay in the system recognizing the updated content. Clément Lacaille noted the error message indicated content flagged by a fact checker, likely due to copyright material, and suggested asking a perplexity AI to refine the video prompt to avoid such issues.
- **Refining Prompts to Avoid Flagged Content** Clément Lacaille instructed Naim Burrack to provide their Excel creative brief and system prompt to analyze the

issue further. After reviewing the system prompt, Clément Lacaille suggested that superhero-like costumes or branded elements like "Dr. Best" could trigger copyright flags. Clément Lacaille then provided a refined brief, designed to be short and avoid copyright or safety issues, for Naim Burrack to use.

- **Continued Workflow Adjustments and Success** Naim Burrack implemented the new brief in their Google Sheet, and Clément Lacaille guided them through retesting the Zapier workflow to ensure the changes were recognized. Despite an initial message about copyright restrictions for familiar superheroes, Naim Burrack edited the video script to remove the problematic content, allowing the workflow to proceed. After several retest attempts and waiting for the video model to process the request, the workflow finally completed successfully, generating the desired video. Naim Burrack expressed significant satisfaction with the outcome, thanking Clément Lacaille for their persistent help.

Suggested next steps

- ☐ Clément Lacaille will add the document to the Google Drive after the class.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will put the simple explanation of HTTP JSON API in the document and share it with the group.
- ☐ The group will complete the automation workflow on Zapier.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will check if the response went through by verifying the credits and run the process on his own to see if it works before letting others run it.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will set up the next node while waiting for the current process to complete and create a new tab called 'output video' in his sheet.
- ☐ Naim Burrack will do the process in his own time because of the copyrighted characters issue.
- ☐ Patrick Wode will stay after class to fix the issue with his image URL.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will provide guidance for the next week's topic which will be a job application automation workflow on NA10.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will figure out how to fix the JSON structure issue related to duration for the sake of the exercise.
- ☐ Clément Lacaille will improve and do a better job next week and improve on whatever mistakes were made this week.
- ☐ Naim Burrack will try running the Zapia with Clément Lacaille's Google sheet on the weekend to understand the process.

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